

Background

Foundation Medicine provides physicians a suite of genomic profiling tests and clinical reporting services designed to identify a cancer patient's biomarkers and unique genetic signatures. Genomic testing supports oncologists' clinical decision making, providing them critical information to help them select treatment pathways, precision oncology therapies, and clinical trials most appropriate for their patients' individual needs.

How does it work?



A patient is newly diagnosed with cancer, is currently being treated for cancer, or is in a clinical trial for a new cancer therapy



When the patient meets with their oncologist, the oncologist suggests comprehensive genomic testing to better understand the patient's unique genetic profile



Dependent on the type of cancer, the patient either has a biopsy or blood drawn. This specimen is sent to Foundation Medicine for testing. The oncologist chooses which Foundation Medicine tests are appropriate, and places the orders the test online, or fills out a paper form



Foundation Medicine receives the order and the specimen and prepares it to be tested. Dependent on the types of testing the oncologist has ordered, the patient's specimen is divided into slides and "accessioned" for genomic sequencing.



Foundation Medicine sequences the patient's specimens, identifying any unique genomic signatures and biomarkers appearing in their DNA and RNA.



Pathologists examine the test results, and prepare a report that details the patient's genomic findings, and identifies approved therapies and precision oncology solutions.



The report is delivered to the oncologist, based on their preferred method of communication. The oncologist then often discusses the report findings with the patient to choose the next step of their cancer care.